

the Halton Hospital in Cheshire, made numerous trips to Cambridge. Kafeel introduced them to the genial Bilal and the four formed a social group. Sabeel and Bilal, in the words of an unnamed friend, "were like clowns, loud and funny, cracking jokes all the time". Late last year, Haneef applied for and got a job with the Gold Coast Hospital, near Brisbane, Australia. Sabeel too applied, but was turned down for lack of experience. He stayed in the UK. Bilal, meanwhile, obtained a one-year post last August at the Inverclyde Royal Hospital in Greenock, Scotland.

Very little is known about Kafeel's lifestyle, except that he attended the mosque every Friday. It was here, many believe that he came in contact with Mohammed Asha, the brilliant 26-year-old Jordanian Palestinian neurosurgeon. A friend from Cambridge said on condition of anonymity that Kafeel seemed pivoted towards a stricter interpretation of Islam by 2005. And he began talking to his friends—some sympathetic and some otherwise—about "fighting for Islam".

**P**olice have unearthed clues of these brothers who had begun professing a puritanical view of Islam by advising their friends to stay off television, save electricity and desist from revelry when they visited Bangalore. Two years ago, they tried to influence worshippers at the Jamia Hazrat Tippu Masjid opposite their home when they condemned as un-Islamic the lights that decorated the mosque. Masjid secretary Samiullah recalls, the authorities gently asking the brothers to desist from imposing their skewed views of Islam on the regulars.

Shiraz Maher—a writer who claims Kafeel was once a member of Hizb-ut-Tahrir—says he knew him in Cambridge. According to him, the two met there and socialised at the Islamic Academy on Gilbert Road. He says he was shocked that Kafeel had such radical views. Jamal Iweida of the Belfast Islamic Center says he knew Kafeel well as a regular visitor and as a person who was active in student Islamic affairs at the Queen's University. "If anything happened to his personality, it was after he left Belfast. He was involved in multi-faith events," Iweida adds.

Kafeel worked from December 2005 to July 2006 as a senior aeronautical engineer for Infotech Enterprises, an Indian outsourcing company that designs aircraft parts for clients including Boeing and Airbus. By now, the radicalisation of Kafeel and Sabeel was complete and Kafeel returned to India with a traditional Muslim beard in place of his goatee. The shy and introvert youth was replaced by a fiery radical who spoke a lot about fighting for Islam as a jihadi. The brothers participated in a raucous protest march in Bangalore, just two months before the

massive, if defective, firebombs which failed to go off in London in the small hours of June 30. And it was Kafeel who apparently brought together his younger brother Sabeel, who was arrested near the hospital where he worked as a doctor in Liverpool shortly after the events at Glasgow airport, and Asha, arrested along with his 27-year-old wife, Marwah, a Palestinian laboratory assistant.

It was apparently in the quiet university town of Cambridge that the plot came together. Many of the suspects frequented the Cambridge Mosque on

## BILAL ABDULLAH: Agent Provocateur

### GENIAL RADICAL

■ Passenger of the Jeep that crashed into Glasgow airport. Qualified as a doctor in Baghdad. Professes extremist Islamic views.

■ Brings Kafeel under his sway after meeting him in Cambridge.



## MOHAMMED ASHA: Co-conspirator



**DOCTOR DOOM** Dr Asha with infant son Anas, mother-in-law Eslah and wife Marwa Da'na while in Amman, Jordan.

### THE DOCTOR

■ Jordanian neurosurgeon. In Cambridge at the same time as Bilal. Meets Ahmed brothers at a mosque in Cambridge.

■ Worked at North Staffordshire Hospital before arrest by British police as a co-conspirator.



December 28, 2005 11sc attack, after a Danish daily published a caricature of Prophet Mohammed. Kafeel headed off to pursue his PhD at the Anglia Polytechnic University in Cambridge only last year.

The London bomb plot appears to have been developed in the three years that Kafeel had been in England after arriving from Northern Ireland. He also suspected of using his engineering skills to turn two Mercedes cars into the

Mawson Road and though the mosque itself is known as moderate and peaceable, it is possible that the conspirators may have come in contact with Hizb-ut-Tahrir. Maher, who is also a friend of Bilal, told the BBC that his friend, who was in Cambridge to study English, "supported the insurgency in Iraq". Maher said, "He actively cheered the deaths of British and American troops in Iraq. One of his best friends had been killed by the Shia militia when he was